

Florence Bookstores Worth Finding

A short list for the trip — from English titles to spectacular spaces

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We're staying near the Duomo and Piazza della Signoria next week, and I did a little research on Florence bookstores worth making time for. Given my reading tastes — Conrad, McCarthy, Mantel, O'Brian, historical fiction, classics — there's a real chance I lose a couple of hours in at least one of these places.

English-Language Books

Paperback Exchange The best-known English-language bookstore in Florence. Large selection of new and used titles, plus a book-exchange program. Only a few minutes from the Duomo, and consistently recommended by travelers and expats as the go-to spot for English books.

laFeltrinelli Book Store Big mainstream bookstore with a solid English-language section. Easy walk from both the Duomo and the train station.

laFeltrinelli (Santa Maria Novella station) The station branch is handy if you arrive by train and want something to read before you've even checked in.

Best Atmosphere

Todo Modo Independent bookstore and café/wine bar — one of the more interesting literary spaces in the city. The kind of place you sit down with a book and suddenly it's been an hour.

Giunti Odeon Built into a restored movie theater near Piazza Strozzi. Spectacular space. Worth a look even if you're not buying anything.

La Cité Bookshop-café in the Oltrarno with readings, events, coffee, and wine. Apparently a local favorite rather than a tourist stop.

Rare & Antique Books

Libreria Gozzini Historic antiquarian bookstore operating out of a Florentine palace. On the list if we have a slow afternoon.

Libreria Giorni Small specialist rare-book shop near the Duomo.

If We Only Have Time for Two

1. **Paperback Exchange** — for English books worth actually buying and carrying home.
2. **Todo Modo** (or Giunti Odeon) — for the uniquely Florentine bookstore experience.